



Cambridge IGCSE™

BIOLOGY

0610/61

Paper 6 Alternative to Practical

May/June 2020

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 40

Published

Students did not sit exam papers in the June 2020 series due to the Covid-19 global pandemic.

This mark scheme is published to support teachers and students and should be read together with the question paper. It shows the requirements of the exam. The answer column of the mark scheme shows the proposed basis on which Examiners would award marks for this exam. Where appropriate, this column also provides the most likely acceptable alternative responses expected from students. Examiners usually review the mark scheme after they have seen student responses and update the mark scheme if appropriate. In the June series, Examiners were unable to consider the acceptability of alternative responses, as there were no student responses to consider.

Mark schemes should usually be read together with the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers. However, because students did not sit exam papers, there is no Principal Examiner Report for Teachers for the June 2020 series.

Cambridge International will not enter into discussions about these mark schemes.

Cambridge International is publishing the mark schemes for the June 2020 series for most Cambridge IGCSE™ and Cambridge International A & AS Level components, and some Cambridge O Level components.

This document consists of **8** printed pages.

Generic Marking Principles

These general marking principles must be applied by all examiners when marking candidate answers. They should be applied alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptors for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme will also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptors for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptors for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always **whole marks** (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded **positively**:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptors.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:

Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however; the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:

Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptors in mind.

Science-Specific Marking Principles

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | Examiners should consider the context and scientific use of any keywords when awarding marks. Although keywords may be present, marks should not be awarded if the keywords are used incorrectly. |
| 2 | The examiner should not choose between contradictory statements given in the same question part, and credit should not be awarded for any correct statement that is contradicted within the same question part. Wrong science that is irrelevant to the question should be ignored. |
| 3 | Although spellings do not have to be correct, spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. ethane / ethene, glucagon / glycogen, refraction / reflection). |
| 4 | The error carried forward (ecf) principle should be applied, where appropriate. If an incorrect answer is subsequently used in a scientifically correct way, the candidate should be awarded these subsequent marking points. Further guidance will be included in the mark scheme where necessary and any exceptions to this general principle will be noted. |

5 'List rule' guidance (see examples below)

For questions that require *n* responses (e.g. State **two** reasons ...):

- The response should be read as continuous prose, even when numbered answer spaces are provided
- Any response marked *ignore* in the mark scheme should not count towards *n*
- Incorrect responses should not be awarded credit but will still count towards *n*
- Read the entire response to check for any responses that contradict those that would otherwise be credited. Credit should **not** be awarded for any responses that are contradicted within the rest of the response. Where two responses contradict one another, this should be treated as a single incorrect response
- Non-contradictory responses after the first *n* responses may be ignored even if they include incorrect science.

6 Calculation specific guidance

Correct answers to calculations should be given full credit even if there is no working or incorrect working, **unless** the question states 'show your working'.

For questions in which the number of significant figures required is not stated, credit should be awarded for correct answers when rounded by the examiner to the number of significant figures given in the mark scheme. This may not apply to measured values.

For answers given in standard form, (e.g. $a \times 10^n$) in which the convention of restricting the value of the coefficient (*a*) to a value between 1 and 10 is not followed, credit may still be awarded if the answer can be converted to the answer given in the mark scheme.

Unless a separate mark is given for a unit, a missing or incorrect unit will normally mean that the final calculation mark is not awarded. Exceptions to this general principle will be noted in the mark scheme.

7 Guidance for chemical equations

Multiples / fractions of coefficients used in chemical equations are acceptable unless stated otherwise in the mark scheme.

State symbols given in an equation should be ignored unless asked for in the question or stated otherwise in the mark scheme.

mark scheme abbreviations

- ; separates marking points
- / alternatives
- **R** reject
- **A** accept (for answers correctly cued by the question, or guidance for examiners)
- **I** ignore as irrelevant
- **AW** alternative wording (where responses vary more than usual)
- **AVP** alternative valid point
- underline actual word given must be used by candidate (grammatical variants excepted)

Question	Answer	Marks
1(a)(i)	5.0 ;	1
1(a)(ii)	(initial temperature) 80 and (final temperature) 60 ;	1
1(a)(iii)	table drawn with two columns and a header row ; column headings with unit: test-tube and time (taken for colour change) / s ; four correct times recorded in seconds (A:36, B:87, C:165, D:90) ;	3
1(a)(iv)	2(%);	1
1(a)(v)	<i>idea of</i> comparing the time for D with A , B and C / B was the closest time to D / AW ;	1
1(b)(i)	<i>error</i> : temperature has decreased ; <i>improvement</i> : maintain temperature by, using a thermostatically controlled water-bath / Bunsen burner / adding hot water throughout the investigation (and monitoring) temperature / insulate beaker / AW ;	2
1(b)(ii)	times are slower as temperature decreases / unable to identify the concentration of glucose in D with certainty / may underestimate the concentration ;	1
1(c)(i)	<i>any two from</i> : volume of glucose solution ; volume of Benedict's solution ; concentration of Benedict's solution ; time for mixing of test-tube contents ;	2
1(c)(ii)	heating liquid (that might spill out of test-tube) / use of Benedict's solution / AW ;	1
1(d)(i)	axes correctly labelled with units: time / minutes and mass of starch remaining / g ; scale evenly spaced and occupying half of the grid in both directions ; five correct plots $\pm$ half a small square ; line joining all five plot points ;	4
1(d)(ii)	mass of starch remaining decreases and levels off / AW ;	1
1(d)(iii)	mass correct from candidate's graph ; graph marked at interpolation to show where reading taken ;	2

Question	Answer	Marks
1(d)(iv)	$(42 \div 5 =) 8.4$ (g per minute) ;	1
1(e)	<i>method:</i> 1&2 use of Benedict's reagent to measure reducing sugar produced, at set time / at regular intervals ; ref. to use of hot water-bath / use of (thermostatically controlled) water-bath to maintain temperatures ; OR use of iodine solution to determine starch remaining ; ref. to drops on spotting tile at regular intervals ; <i>independent variable:</i> 3 ref. to using at least two different temperatures ; <i>variables kept constant – max two from mp 4-8:</i> 4 same type of enzyme ; 5 concentration of starch suspension ; 6 concentration of enzyme ; 7 same pH ; 8 incubating enzymes and starch suspension for same time ; <i>dependent variable:</i> 9 concentration of reducing sugar produced / time taken for drops and iodine solution to remain brown ; 10 ref. to at least two further replications / repeat investigation two more times ; 11 ref. to relevant safety precaution ;	6

Question	Answer	Marks
2(a)(i)	line AB = 70 ± 1 mm and line CD = 22 ± 1 mm ;	1
2(a)(ii)	(x)700 / 710 / 690 ;	1
2(a)(iii)	0.03 mm ;;;	3

Question	Answer	Marks
2(b)(i)	outline: has clear single lines without shading ; size: occupies at least half the space available ; details: correct proportions sperm and ovum ; shape of sperm – round / oval head and long tail ; ovum labelled with label line touching the ovum ;	5
2(b)(ii)	any three from: ovum is larger than the sperm ; ovum is round, sperm long and thin ; ovum has rough surface, sperm is smooth ; ovum has a uniform shape, sperm is wider at one end ;	3